



Work hard, play harder

Introducing Tynker - a startup that teaches kids to code robots, drones and more:
<http://dgit.in/1FDHZV>



Burner a.k.a Shuffle

Shuffle, a new mobile app that lets you create disposable phone numbers and much more:
<http://dgit.in/1EZuJzcg>

DO

Driver Software” option. Then follow Browse my computer for driver software > Let me pick from a list of device drivers on my computer. Select “Show all devices” and then click on “Next”.

Now, navigate to the Google USB Driver package we had installed earlier with Android SDK. Click on “Have Disk” and browse to the following path C:_Android_folder_\sdk\extras\google\usb_driver\android_winusb.inf (where “_Android_folder_” is the directory where you have installed Android SDK). You will now be able to see your device listed under Device Manager.

It's time to test whether the “Android Debug Bridge” (ADB) is working fine. Go to your Android SDK directory, by following android-sdk-windows > platform-tools. Holding the shift button, right-click anywhere on the explorer to open the right-click menu.

Click on Open command option here and the Command Prompt opens in the current directory. This is more convenient than opening Command Prompt and then navigating to the desired directory. Enter the command `adb version`, and if it displays the version of the adb installed, you're good to go. If you're interested in knowing more about ADB and its commands, visit the following tutorial <http://dgit.in/ADBTut> to get detailed indepth steps .

Other necessary tools

Creating your own Android theme requires various tools, one of which is a decompiling tool that unpacks the apk files of the framework and your device's system files. For this tutorial we will use the Windows based “Apktool”, which can be downloaded from <http://dgit.in/Apktool>.

If you want all files in a single location – including adb, smali, backsmali, sign, and zipalign – you can download Apktool from http://dgit.in/Apktool2_9. If apktool fails to run, replace the “apktool.jar” file downloaded from the previous link. The download page also has requisite instructions to ensure a clean install. Once installed, follow the same method mentioned above to open the Command Prompt in the Apktool directory and check if it's running by entering the `apktool` command.

To unpack and pack certain files and create flashable zips, you will require either “7-Zip” or “WinRAR”. We recommend WinRAR. To edit icons and images for your theme, you will need either GIMP or Photoshop.

GIMP is a great option since it's a free software sporting all features required for theming. To make it easier to edit the .9 png images. Note: .9 files are essentially png images with 1-pixel wide borders. You can download “Draw9patch” from <http://dgit.in/Draw9patch> (download the “Better 9 patch tool”). Modifying the layout, text, font colours, and more requires

editing the xml codes, which is easier done using Notepad++.

Pulling the apks from your phone

With all necessary tools and packages installed, you can begin by pulling required apk files from your phone. There are three methods for obtaining the apk files:

1 If you have downloaded the stock ROM or any custom ROM for your device, you can simply explore to the desired apk file. Once you root your phone, you get access to all the system files on your phone and the apk files as well.

2 With any file browser app that can access the system files, you can obtain the required apks.

3 Using the adb command is an efficient way of pulling the required or all apks in one go. To do that, open the Command Prompt from the Apktool directory and enter the following command `adb pull /system/app/ Apps_backup`. This will pull the entire app folder to a folder named “Apps_backup”.

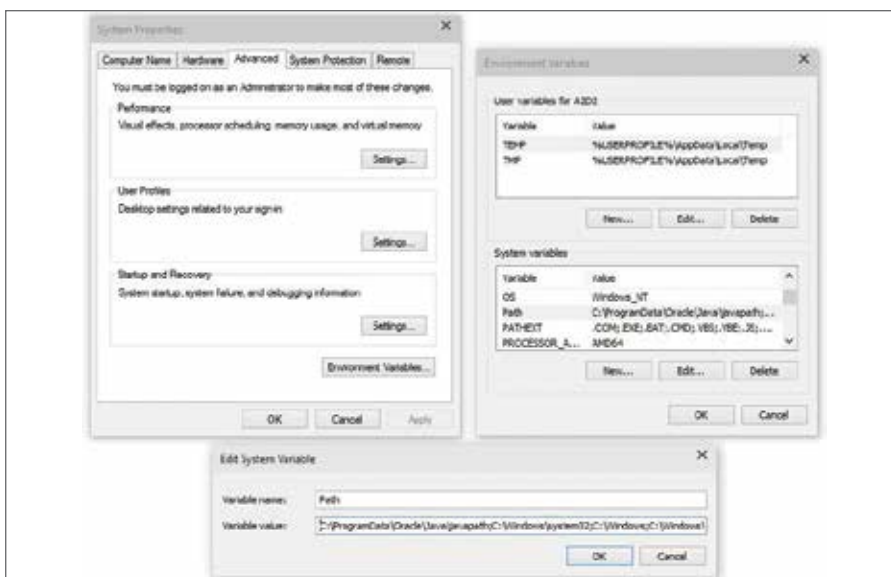
Thereafter, you can copy the requisite apps a different folder. Theming also requires framework files. These can be obtained by entering the command `adb pull /system/framework Framework_backup`. Now, you can find all the framework files in the “Framework_backup” folder.

Decompiling

Before you start decompiling the apks that you have pulled in the previous step, you must install the required resources, which happen to be other apk files. Essentially, you'll need two resource apk files – one found in the frameworks folder named “framework-res.apk”, whereas the other one is “SystemUI.apk”.

In most cases, it can be found in the app backup folder pulled earlier. In case you don't find the SystemUI.apk file in the backup folder, you might have to pull the apk from a different folder by entering the command `adb pull /system/priv_app Priv_app_backup`.

To install the resources , open the command window in the Apktool directory and enter the commands `apktool if`



Adding environment variables for JAVA